RG DEVS

RG HotelOS User Manual

Every screen, for every role: reception, restaurant, cashier and M-Pesa, finance, pay, stock, housekeeping, reports, backups, updates, licence and the assistant.

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1 How RG HotelOS works

RG HotelOS runs the whole hotel from one office PC, called the **server**. The hotel's data lives on that PC. Staff use tablets, phones or PCs on the hotel Wi-Fi and open RG HotelOS in their web browser. Nothing needs the internet except M-Pesa prompts, Google Drive backups, licence renewal, updates and the AI assistant, so the hotel keeps working when the internet is down.

- Keep the server PC on, plugged into a UPS and wired to the router.
- Each device is approved once by a manager (Devices). After that, staff sign in on it with their own username and PIN.
- Every screen shows only what the person's role allows. Money is never deleted or edited: mistakes are reversed with a reason, and the Audit log records who did what.

2 Signing in

1. Type your **username** (capitals don't matter), then your **6-digit PIN** on the PIN pad.
2. The first time, you sign in with the temporary PIN the manager gave you and must choose your own PIN.
3. A PIN may not be all the same digit or a run like 123456.

Signing out by itself: a device signs you out when it is not used. Floor roles (cashier, waiter, kitchen, bar, housekeeping) are signed out after 2 minutes; office roles (admin, manager, finance, reception, store) after 15 minutes. The admin can change these times in Settings.

Wrong PIN: after 5 wrong PINs the account is locked for 5 minutes, then 15, then 60. After that, a manager or the admin unlocks it (Staff → the person → Unlock now). A correct PIN resets the count.

Change your PIN: your name at the top right → Account → change PIN.

Forgotten PIN: a manager or the admin resets it (Staff → the person → Reset PIN) and gives you a new temporary PIN. If the only admin forgot their PIN, use the **admin recovery key** printed at setup.

3 Roles: who does what

Role	Main screens
Admin	Everything, including Settings, Powers, M-Pesa, Backups and updates, Licence
Manager	Day-to-day running: reception, restaurant, staff, approvals, attendance, reports
Finance	Finance (expenses, imprest), Pay, Cashier checks of M-Pesa codes, reports
Receptionist	Reception, Rooms, the clock-in point
Cashier	Cashier: shift, payments, receipts
Waiter	Orders: tables, takeaway, room service
Kitchen / Bar	Kitchen screen and printed tickets
Housekeeping	Housekeeping: rooms to clean, faults
Storekeeper	Stock: products, deliveries, counts

The manager may give any role except Admin and Finance, which only the admin gives. **Powers** (admin) switches on a few optional extras, for example letting the manager approve imprest or see salaries.

4 Home screen

Each person's Home shows what matters for their role:

- **Admin and manager:** earned today, money in today (cash and M-Pesa), occupancy, open orders, arrivals and departures, bills waiting, debtors, expenses this month, imprest waiting, unverified M-Pesa codes and **alerts**.
- **Alerts** (red or yellow banners): printer not answering, backup problems, the server's clock was changed, an update is ready or failed, the licence, low disk space. Press **Seen** once dealt with.
- Shortcuts such as **Book or check in**, **New order** and **Report a fault**.

5 Reception

Reception opens on the **room grid**. Each room shows its number, type, the guest's name and its status: Available, Reserved, Occupied, Cleaning or Maintenance. The counters at the top filter the grid.

Tabs: Rooms, Arrivals, Departures, In house, Upcoming, Debtors, Rate changes, Night audit.

Walk-in and new booking

1. **Walk-in** (guest arriving now) or **New booking** (a reservation).

2. **Find a guest** by name or phone; returning guests fill in by themselves.
3. Otherwise enter **Full name**, **Phone**, **ID type** (National ID or Passport), **ID / passport number**, **Nationality**, and optionally vehicle registration and notes.
4. Choose the room, dates and adults. The rate comes from the room type's rack rate. A different rate needs a **reason**; a discount beyond the reception limit needs a manager's PIN on the same device.
5. **Payment: Pay after the stay** (default) or **Pay before check-in** (the guest pays first).
6. Save. A walk-in is checked in at once.

ID numbers are stored encrypted and shown in full only to roles that need them.

A booking

Open a booking from the grid or a list. You can:

- **Check in** (a reservation) and **Check out**. Checking out with money owed needs payment first, or a manager's approval to let the guest leave owing; they then appear under **Debtors**.
- **Add charge** (laundry, extras), with what it was for. **Reverse** a charge with a reason (charges are never deleted).
- **Change dates**, **Change rate** (with a reason), **Move room** (choose whether the old room is free for the rest of the stay).
- **Refund credit** when the guest paid more than the stay. **Cancel** or mark **No-show** a reservation.
- **History** shows every change and who made it.

Night audit

Every night (default 23:59) the night audit puts each occupied room's night on the guest's bill and prints the **day close (Z) report**. If the server was off at that time, it catches up when it starts; Reception → Night audit → **Run any due audit now** does it at once.

6 Rooms

Rooms (manager or admin): room types with their **rack rate per night**, **most adults**, and the rooms of each type (**Add a room**: number, type, optional floor). **Stay rules:** checkout time, the largest discount reception may give (%), and the default payment (pay after the stay, or pay before check-in). A room can be put **Not in use**.

7 Housekeeping

1. After checkout a room shows **To clean**. Housekeeping presses **Cleaned**.
2. A supervisor or manager inspects: **Inspected: ready** (the room becomes Available) or **Send back** with what needs doing again.
3. **Report a fault** (anyone): what is wrong and where. A room with a fault can be taken out of use. Maintenance marks it **Fixed** with what was done.

If the hotel has no housekeeping department, reception marks rooms ready itself.

8 Restaurant and bar

Taking an order (waiter)

1. **Orders** → choose a **table**, **Takeaway** or **Room service** (room service goes on the guest's bill).
2. Tap items to add them; add a **Note** for the kitchen ("no onions").
3. Send. Each item prints at its station (kitchen or bar) and shows on the kitchen screen.

On an order you can **Add items**, **Cancel items** (with a reason; items already being prepared need a manager), **Transfer** to another table, **Charge to room**, and mark **Served to the guest**.

Kitchen and bar

The **Kitchen screen** shows tickets as they arrive (it refreshes every few seconds). Press **Mark ready** when a dish is ready; the waiter sees it. Printed tickets work without the screen.

Menu (manager)

Menu → **Add category** (each category prints at a station) → **Add item** with its price. An item that runs out can be switched off with one tap and back on later.

9 Printers

Printers (admin): **Add printer**: a **Network (LAN)** printer by its IP address (from its self-test page) or a **USB** printer attached to the server; choose the paper width. Press **Test print**.

Stations (**Add station**): Kitchen, Bar and so on: which printer prints each station's tickets, and whether the station has a kitchen screen. Choose which printer prints receipts.

If a printer stops answering, tickets wait and an alert shows; they print once it is back, never twice. A ticket that failed part-way is marked **uncertain**: staff decide whether to **Reprint** it (marked REPRINT) or press **It printed**. Any ticket or receipt can be reprinted or sent to another printer.

10 Cashier

Shift

1. **Open shift** with the float in the drawer. No payment can be taken without an open shift.
2. At the end, **Close shift**: count the cash. The difference from what was expected is recorded, and differences above the limit are flagged on the shift report.

Taking payment

Bills waiting lists restaurant orders and guests' bills. Choose a bill → **Take payment**:

- **Cash:** enter the amount given; the change is shown.
- **M-Pesa prompt:** enter the customer's phone and send. The customer enters their PIN on their phone. The bill is paid only when Safaricom confirms; the receipt shows the M-Pesa code. If nothing happens, **Check now**, or pay another way.
- **M-Pesa code** (customer paid by paybill or till directly): type the code. It stays **unverified** until finance checks it against the M-Pesa statement (Cashier → M-Pesa checks).
- Card and bank: record with a reference.

A payment can cover several bills, and a bill can be paid in parts. Receipts print on the receipt printer.

New bill (sundry bill) is for walk-in sales that aren't orders or rooms, e.g. a conference room.

Reversing a payment needs a reason; reversals on a checked-out guest's bill need a manager. An M-Pesa reversal is recorded here; sending the money back is done in the M-Pesa business portal.

11 M-Pesa setup (admin)

M-Pesa screen:

1. **Type**: Paybill or Till (Buy Goods), the number, and the **Account reference** shown to the customer.
2. **Environment**: Sandbox for testing (Safaricom's public test shortcode and passkey are filled in), Production for real money.
3. The Daraja **consumer key**, **consumer secret** and **passkey** (emailed by Safaricom at Go Live). They are stored encrypted on the server and never sent to tablets.
4. **Save**, then **Send test** (KES 1 to a phone).

"Connected to the RG Devs relay" means Safaricom's answers reach the hotel through RG Devs' relay. Every payment is still confirmed directly with Safaricom before a bill is marked paid.

12 Finance

Expenses: Record expense with the category, department, amount, how it was paid, a reference and an optional supplier. Expenses are never deleted; **Void** with a reason. Manage **Categories**, **Suppliers** and **Fixed costs** (rent, internet: **Record this month** posts them).

Imprest (cash advanced for purchases):

1. **Requisition** (Form 1): requester, department, purpose and the lines.
2. **Approval**: the approver approves an amount, or rejects. By default no new imprest is given while the same person has an unsurrendered one, unless the approver gives a reason.
3. **Record money issued** (cash or M-Pesa with the code).
4. **Surrender** (Form 2): what was spent, change returned, receipts attached or not. **Save surrender and post expenses** turns it into expenses.

Print blank requisition forms for staff who fill them by hand. Forms print on A4 from the browser.

13 Pay

Pay (finance; admin):

- **Salaries: Set salary** (gross monthly, effective from).
- **Advances: Record advance** (amount, how paid); advances are taken off the next pay sheet.
- **Pay sheet:** choose the month; it stays a draft until **Prepare and lock**. **Print sheet** and **Print slips**.

14 Attendance

At the **clock-in point** (a device marked as one, usually the reception tablet), staff **Clock in** and **Clock out** with their own username and PIN. A manager can **Clock someone in/out** and **Add correction** with a reason. **Shift start** and **grace minutes** decide what counts as late. Attendance shows who is in and the monthly record.

15 Stock

Stock (storekeeper; manager):

- **Products:** name, category, **base unit** (bottle, kg…), **packs** (a crate = 24 bottles) and the **reorder level**.
- **Receive delivery:** supplier, invoice, each product with its pack, quantity and cost. Stock goes up at cost. Paying the supplier is recorded in Finance.
- **Adjust** (damaged, lost): with a reason.
- **Recipes:** what a menu item uses, and **when to deduct** (when ordered or when served).
- **Stock count: Start a stock count**, enter what is on the shelf, **Save progress**, then **Finish count and set stock**. The difference is posted. Count when the store is quiet.

Low stock shows on the home screen.

16 Reports

Reports → choose a report and a period (today, yesterday, this month, this quarter, this year, or dates) → **Excel** or **Print / PDF**. Reports include: revenue by department, money received by method, revenue by menu item, revenue by waiter, money taken by cashier, cash-up variances, rooms: occupancy and rates, rate adjustments, debtors, expenses, expenses by category and department, imprest, stock valuation and stock movements. **Day close (Z)** can be reprinted for any business day.

17 Staff, devices and powers

Staff (manager, admin): **Add staff member** (full name, username, role) → **Add and get temporary PIN**: give the PIN to the person privately. Open a person to change their role or status (deactivate when they leave),

Reset PIN, or **Unlock now**. **Staff record and activity** shows what they did.

Devices (manager, admin): a new tablet or phone shows a 6-digit code. Enter it under **Devices** → **Approve**. Name each device, mark the reception tablet as the **clock-in point**, and **Remove device** for a lost one.

Connecting a device: on the hotel Wi-Fi, scan the QR code on the server's setup page (or type the address shown under Health → Network), install the hotel's certificate as shown, then wait for approval. On tablets use **Add to home screen**.

Powers (admin): optional extras for roles, e.g. "Manager can approve imprest", "Manager can see salaries".

18 Settings (admin)

- **Business:** hotel name, phone, logo, location; they appear on every screen and printout.
- **Departments:** switch on what the hotel has (rooms, restaurant, bar, kitchen, store, housekeeping). Menus and roles follow the list.
- **Security:** how long each role stays signed in without use, and the longest a sign-in lasts.
- **Demo data: Load demo data** to practise; **Clear demo data** removes exactly what was loaded.

19 Backups and updates

Backups happen by themselves: a copy every 15 minutes on the server, a daily copy to the USB drive when it is plugged in, and to Google Drive if connected.

1. **Make the recovery key** and **print the Backup Recovery Sheet**. Keep it away from the server. Without it, backups cannot be opened, by the hotel or by RG Devs.
2. Plug in a USB stick → **Use for backups**. Plug it in every day or two; it copies by itself. An alert shows if it has not been plugged in for 3 days.
3. **Connect Google Drive** (optional): the owner signs in on their phone; a daily copy goes to the hotel's own Drive.
4. **Run restore test** checks that a backup opens. **Restore...** brings a backup back (on a new PC: choose **Restore a backup instead** on the first setup screen, then type the recovery key).

How long things are kept: quick copies (days), daily copies (number), the USB warning, and how long guests' ID numbers and contacts are kept after their last stay (7 years by default, Kenya Data Protection Act).

Updates from RG Devs download and install by themselves only in the **quiet hours** (02:00 to 05:00 by default), once no order, M-Pesa payment or staff member has been active for the set minutes. If a new version does not start properly, the previous version and its data are put back by themselves, and an alert says so. **Check now** downloads a new version straight away; **Install now** installs it.

20 Licence

Licence (admin):

- **Start a free trial**: 14 days with every feature, once per computer.
- **Buy with M-Pesa**: choose a plan (1 week KES 150, 1 month KES 1,000, 12 months KES 10,000, Lifetime KES 30,000), enter the M-Pesa phone and approve the prompt. The licence turns on by itself, even if the screen is closed or the PC restarts after paying. Buying again before a plan ends adds the time to the end.
- **I have a key**: type a key from RG Devs.
- When a trial ends, new sales stop, but every screen, report and backup still works. When a paid plan ends, a reminder shows; renew under Buy with M-Pesa.
- **Contact RG Devs** (email or WhatsApp) sends the hotel name and this computer's machine code, for example to move the licence to a new PC.

The server needs the internet only to start, buy or renew a licence; it renews by itself every few hours when online.

21 The assistant

The **Ask** button (bottom right) opens the assistant.

- **Help** works without the internet: it answers from this manual and offers quick actions.
- **AI assistant** (when the admin has added the hotel's Gemini API key under Settings → Assistant, and the internet is on): ask in plain words, for example "how many rooms are free tonight?" or "check in the guest in 104".
- It only sees and does what **your own role** allows. Anything that changes something is shown first as an action to **Confirm**; nothing changes until you press it.
- Questions and the data needed to answer them go to Google under the hotel's own key. ID numbers and phone numbers are never sent.

22 Health and troubleshooting

Health (admin) shows the server, database, disk space, backups and printers.

Problem	What to do
A tablet can't reach the server	Check it is on the hotel Wi-Fi, the server PC is on, and the address is right. Restart the tablet's browser.
"This device is not approved"	A manager approves it under Devices.
Tickets don't print	Printers → Test print. Check the printer's power, paper and network cable. Tickets wait and print when it is back.
M-Pesa prompt not confirmed	Wait a minute; press Check now. If the customer paid, the code arrives; otherwise pay another way.
"Could not reach the RG Devs licence service"	Connect the server to the internet (a phone hotspot is fine) and try again.
Update failed and was put back	Nothing to do: the hotel runs on the previous version. RG Devs releases a fix.
Disk nearly full	Delete old files from the server PC or ask RG Devs. Backups stop when the disk is full.
Forgotten admin PIN	Use the admin recovery key from setup.
Server broken or stolen	New PC → install RG HotelOS → Restore a backup instead → USB drive or Google Drive file → recovery key. Contact RG Devs to move the licence.

23 Data protection

The hotel is responsible for its guests' and staff's data (Kenya Data Protection Act, 2019). RG HotelOS collects only what is needed, encrypts ID numbers, shows them only to roles that need them, and erases ID numbers, phones, emails and vehicles after the retention period. Put a notice at reception explaining why ID is collected, keep backups and the recovery sheet safe, and register with the ODPC if required.

24 Support

RG Devs: email **rgdev.ke@gmail.com**, WhatsApp **+254 140 205 383**. The Licence screen's Email and WhatsApp buttons send the hotel name and machine code for you. Website, guides, privacy policy and terms: https://kenrodgersutugi-tech.github.io/rg-hotelos-releases/